OOS Number: OOS- 262329

Phase I

Section A – Test Details					
Initiator:	Guanchen Li (Written by Qiyue Chen)	**Test Date:**	23-Sep-2026	**Date Initiated:**	13-Oct-2026
Date of Incident:	13-Oct-2026	**Test Name:**	USP <71> / EP 2.6.1 Sterility Test	**Sample ID:**	ETX-260624-0251 (BUD-T90)
Name of Analyst who Performed the Test:	Prepping Analyst: Elysse Nioupin (EN) Processing Analyst: Guanchen Li (GL) Subculture Analyst: Ayomide Odugbesi (AOD) Reading Analyst: Andrew Carrillo (ANC)	**Sample / Active Name**	Sermorelin 0.9mg/ml	**Lot #:**	17009
		Dosage Form	Liquid		
Description of Incident:	On 13-Oct-2026, sample ETX-260624-0251 (BUD-T90) was found positive for viable microorganisms after USP <71> sterility testing.	☑ Client Care notified of OOS ☑ Sterility and Endotoxin test related OOS; Client must be notified within 24 hours of OOS			
	SOP / Test Method #: MICRO-SOP-5	Effective Date: 24Jul2026	SOP / Test Method Rev: 19	Limits/Specification: Pass/Fail	
Manager notified	Manager/designee name: Kathan Parikh	Date: 13-Oct-2026	Quality Assurance Department notified:	Yes ☑ No ☐	

Section B – Investigation and Root Cause Analysis			
Personnel Discrepancy		**Comments**	
Analyst interviewed?	☑Yes ☐ No ☐ N/A	Yes, analysts Elysse Nioupin, Guanchen Li, Ayomide Odugbesi, and Andrew Carrillo were comprehensively interviewed.	
Correct samples analyzed?	☑Yes ☐ No ☐ N/A	Yes, Sample ID: ETX-260624-0251	
Correct SOP / Test Method used/followed?	☑Yes ☐ No ☐ N/A	Yes, as per MICRO-SOP-5	
Correct sample collection/technique?	☑Yes ☐ No ☐ N/A	Yes, as per MICRO-SOP-5	
Are the Test Result Records Attached & Calculations Verified and Correct?	☑Yes ☐ No ☐ N/A	Yes, information is available on EagleTrax under ETX-260624-0251 (BUD-T90)	
Is the analyst qualified to perform the test?	☑Yes ☐ No ☐ N/A	Yes, the analysts are trained and qualified by quality to perform the test.	
Is formula worksheet provided and verified?	☐Yes ☐ No ☑ N/A	Not Applicable	
Does the processing method/method set conform to the required specification?	☐Yes ☐ No ☑ N/A	Not Applicable	
Was the sample stored appropriately?	☑Yes ☐ No ☐ N/A	Yes, the sample was stored refrigerated as per client's instructions	
Material Discrepancy		**Lot Number**	**Expiry Date**
Is the integrity of the sample(s) questionable?	☐Yes ☑ No ☐N/A		
Was the sample transported appropriately?	☑Yes ☐ No ☐N/A		
Are the other test results from this run under investigation?	☐Yes ☑ No ☐N/A		

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Appropriate/correct glassware used?	☐Yes ☐ No ☑N/A		
Are reagents stored in proper condition and not expired?	☑Yes ☐ No ☐N/A	Process Consumables: Information is available in EagleTrax Sample Consumables section Environmental Plates: TSA and Surface Plate: see attached environmental logs Monthly Cleaning: H2O2 strips and IPA: See attached monthly cleaning logs	Process Consumables: Information is available in EagleTrax Sample Consumables section Environmental Plates: TSA and Surface Plate: see attached environmental logs Monthly Cleaning: H2O2 strips and IPA: See attached monthly cleaning logs
Standard Used	Not Applicable	Not Applicable	Not Applicable
Solvent Used	Not Applicable	Not Applicable	Not Applicable
Is the standard the source of the root cause?	☐Yes ☐ No ☑N/A		
Has the analyst been instructed to keep the original test solution for possible retesting?	☐Yes ☐ No ☑N/A		
Equipment Discrepancy		**Equipment ID**	**Calibration Due Date**
Was the instrument set up correctly?	☑Yes ☐ No ☐ N/A	ISO 5 BSC E001314	Jun 2027
Is the clean room facility certified?	☑Yes ☐ No ☐ N/A	E001737 (CR115)	Dec 2026
System Performance Check (if applicable)?	☐Yes ☐ No ☑ N/A	Not Applicable	Not Applicable
System Suitability RSD < 2% (PDA)?	☐Yes ☐ No ☑ N/A	Not Applicable	Not Applicable
System Suitability RSD < 10% (QDA, CAD)?	☐Yes ☐ No ☑ N/A	Not Applicable	Not Applicable
Do the environmental monitoring results conform to required standards?	☑Yes ☐ No ☐ N/A	Phase I Summary	Phase I Summary
Do the controls (i.e., positive, negative, etc.) conform to the required standards?	☑Yes ☐ No ☐ N/A	Phase I Summary	Phase I Summary
Is equipment/instrument functional and calibrated/qualified/certified/PM?	☑Yes ☐ No ☐ N/A	Incubator E001356 (Sensor E001450) Incubator E001357 (Sensor E001449)	Jan 2027 Feb 2027 Jan 2027 Feb 2027

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Are chromatogram/spectra/raw data correct?	☐ Yes ☐ No ☑ N/A	Not Applicable	Not Applicable

Section C – Evaluation of Laboratory Testing/Hypothesis Testing (if applicable)

- ☐ N/A
- ☐ Re-injection of sample vial
- ☐ Re-injection of original standard vial
- ☐ Re-vialing of original working standard solution
- ☐ Re-vialing of original working sample solution
- ☐ Re-dilution of a working sample solution from the original stock
- ☐ Re-dilution of a working standard solution from the original stock standard
- ☐ Other: N/A QYC 28Oct26

Section D – Phase I Summary

Phase I Summary:

All analysts involved in the preparation, processing, subculture, and reading of the sample - Elysse Nioupin, Guanchen Li, Ayomide Odugbesi, and Andrew Carrillo - were interviewed comprehensively. Their responses are documented throughout this report. This investigation was conducted in accordance with MICRO-SOP-53, Sterility Test Out-of-Specification Investigation Procedure.

Upon arrival on 24Jun26, the sample was stored refrigerated in accordance with the client's instructions as part of a beyond-use date study (BUD-T90). Prepping analyst Elysse Nioupin and processing analyst Guanchen Li verified the physical integrity and packaging of the sample throughout the preparation and processing stages. No leaks, cracks, or visible turbidity were observed, verifying container closure integrity prior to testing.

All reagents and supplies mentioned in the material section above were stored according to supplier recommendations, and their integrity was visually verified before utilization. Moreover, all reagents, culture media, and consumables had valid expiration dates. The functionality of all equipment was confirmed by reviewing data generated by our comprehensive in-house continuous monitoring system.

The cleanroom suite (CR 115) used for processing procedures comprises three interconnected sections: the innermost ISO 7 cleanroom (115B), which connects to the middle ISO 7 buffer room (115A), and then to the outermost ISO 8 anteroom (115). Outward-cascading positive air pressure differentials are continuously maintained across the suite to ensure controlled, unidirectional airflow from 115B through 115A and into 115.

The ISO 5 Biological Safety Cabinet (BSC) E001314, located in innermost ISO 7 room 115B, was used for sample processing steps. It was thoroughly cleaned and disinfected prior to each procedure in accordance with MICRO-SOP-2 (Environmental Monitoring of the Clean-room Facility) and MICRO-SOP-9 (Cleaning and Disinfecting Procedure for Microbiology). Additionally, BSC E001314 was certified and approved by Engineering and Quality Assurance.

On 22Sep26, sample prep was performed by Elysse Nioupin. On 23Sep26, sample vials for ETX-260624-0251 (BUD-T90) were retrieved from controlled refrigerated storage and brought into the sterile microbiology suite. Sample container surfaces were sprayed with acidified bleach disinfectant, placed into pre-disinfected transfer bins, and allowed a verified 10-minute contact time. Secondary disinfection with acidified bleach was performed in the ISO 8 anteroom (115) with an additional 10-minute contact time. Inside innermost ISO 7 cleanroom 115B, processing analyst Guanchen Li performed a final disinfection step before transferring the containers into the ISO 5 BSC E001314.

Inside BSC E001314, containers were aseptically accessed with minimal exposure to the ISO 5 environment. Testing was executed by direct inoculation in strict accordance with approved method suitability ETX-260401-0599 and MICRO-SOP-5 (USP <71> / EP 2.6.1 Sterility Test). Specifically, 15 mL of sterile Tween 80 (Lot 0000743947, Exp 31 Jan 2030) and 5 mL of sample were directly inoculated into 200 mL media bottles of Tryptic Soy Broth (TSB, Lot 1012062790, Exp 07/21/2027) and Fluid Thioglycollate Medium (FTM, Lot 1012062800, Exp 07/21/2027). Matching direct inoculation negative control bottles were prepared concurrently and manipulated identically. The inoculated media bottles were transferred into calibrated incubators E001356 (20-25 °C) and E001357 (30-35 °C) to commence incubation.

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Phase I Summary (continued):

On 08Oct26 (Day 14 read), initial test results were recorded as Inconclusive due to formulation-induced turbidity inherent to the concentrated Sermorelin sample matrix. In accordance with USP <71> and laboratory procedure for turbid samples, aliquots were aseptically subcultured into fresh media bottles on 07Oct26 by analyst Ayomide Odugbesi and returned to incubation.

On 12Oct26 (Day 18 of the original bottles and Day 5 of the subculture aliquots), microbial growth was observed and confirmed in both original TSB bottle and subcultured TSB bottle (2 x 200mL TSB, Original and Subculture Bottles) by reading analyst Andrew Carrillo and verified by laboratory supervisor. The FTM media bottles (original and subculture) remained clear and negative (No Growth) throughout the entire incubation period. Positive TSB bottles were submitted for Differential Staining and Microbial Identification under submission ETX-261012-0367. Differential staining indicated Gram-positive rods. Definitive identification confirmed the isolate as Bacillus megaterium, as detailed in Table 1.

All culture media and consumables utilized were within their valid manufacturer expiration dates. Negative control media bottles for direct inoculation were manipulated and incubated alongside the test samples under identical conditions; both TSB and FTM negative controls demonstrated complete absence of microbial growth (No Growth), verifying media sterility and aseptic technique.

Attached Table 2 details the environmental monitoring data associated with sample processing on 23Sep26. Environmental monitoring plates were incubated in accordance with MICRO-SOP-2, Environmental Monitoring of the Clean-room Facility. Review of contemporaneous personnel monitoring (left- and right-hand touch plates for analyst Guanchen Li) and ISO 5 BSC E001314 monitoring (surface contact plates and settling plates) demonstrated No Growth across all sampling locations on the date of testing (23Sep26), the date before testing (22Sep26), and the date after testing (24Sep26). These data confirm that processing personnel and the ISO 5 BSC were maintained in an optimal state of microbiological control and were not a source of contamination.

Routine weekly surface sampling of Cleanroom Suite 115 performed on 23Sep26 demonstrated No Growth. Weekly active-air sampling of the outermost ISO 8 Room 115 recovered 6 CFUs (ETX-261001-0625). Microbial identification confirmed these isolates as Micrococcus luteus, Kocuria indica, Kocuria rhizophila, and one pending fungal isolate (Pending FunITS, exhibiting hyphae morphology). Crucially, all recovered environmental isolates were Gram-positive cocci or fungal hyphae, different from the Gram-positive spore-forming rod (Bacillus megaterium) detected in the positive test sample, with zero Bacillus species recovered in the cleanroom environment. Furthermore, outermost Room 115 functions as an ISO 8 anteroom that is physically separated from innermost cleanroom 115B and the ISO 5 processing zone by cascaded airlocks and positive pressure differentials. The complete absence of microbial recovery across all critical ISO 7 rooms (115A and 115B), personnel gloves, and ISO 5 BSC surfaces confirms that room air contaminants did not enter the ISO 5 critical work area.

Monthly cleaning and disinfection of the cleanrooms (ISO 7) and their containing biosafety cabinets (ISO 5) were performed on 13Sep26 for Suite 115, as per MICRO-SOP-9, Cleaning and Disinfecting Procedure for Microbiology. It was documented that all chemical indicators passed, which confirmed the efficient monthly cleaning of all cleanrooms in Suite 115.

Analyzing a 6-month sample history for GoGoMeds Select (E10747), this specific analyte "Sermorelin 0.9mg/ml" has had no prior Out-of-Specification (OOS) occurrences under USP <71> sterility testing.

To assess the potential for sample-to-sample contamination contributing to the positive results, a comprehensive review was conducted of all samples processed on the same day. All other samples processed by the analyst that day tested negative. These findings suggest that cross-contamination between samples is highly unlikely.

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Phase I Summary (continued):

Based on the laboratory investigation outlined above, no laboratory equipment malfunction, media contamination, environmental excursion, or analyst error was identified. Contemporaneous negative controls and ISO 5 critical zone monitoring remained clear and free of contamination. Therefore, the likelihood of laboratory error contributing to this failure is considered minimal, and the original result is deemed valid.

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Has root cause been identified as a possible laboratory error?
Note: Root cause must be conclusive, verifiable, and well-documented.

☐ Yes
- ☐ If retesting is ***required***, complete Phase II of the OOS (initiate Form 3.100.019.F02).

☑ No, the OOS result is valid.

Reviewer comment(s):
Not Applicable

Prepared by (*Print*)**:**	Signature/Date:
Qiyue Chen	
Lab Manager/Designee (*Print*)**:**	Signature/Date:
Robin Seymour	

Section E – Quality Disposition

Can investigation be closed?

☐ Yes
- ☐ Original result is valid.

☐ No, initiate Form 3.100.019.F02.

Approved by QA Representative (*Print*)**:**	Signature/Date:

Table 1: Information for ETX-260624-0251 (BUD-T90) under investigation

Processing Analyst	Reading Analyst	Sample ID	Related Microbial ID	Media with microbial growth	Microbial ID
Guanchen Li	Andrew Carrillo	ETX-260624-0251 (BUD-T90)	ETX-261012-0367	2 x 200mL TSB (Original and Subculture Bottles)	*Bacillus megaterium* (Gram (+) rods)

Table 2: Environmental Monitoring from Testing Performed on 23Sep26

Environmental Monitoring (EM) Sampling Site	Frequency	Date (DDMMMYY)	Analyst	Day /Week(s)	Observation	EM Plate ETX Number	Microbial ID	Notes
Personnel EM								
Personnel (Left Touch and Right Touch)	Daily	22Sep26	GL	Date Before Testing	No Growth	Not Applicable	Not Applicable	None
Personnel (Left Touch and Right Touch)	Daily	23Sep26	GL	Date of Testing	No Growth	Not Applicable	Not Applicable	None
Personnel (Left Touch and Right Touch)	Daily	24Sep26	GL	Date After Testing	No Growth	Not Applicable	Not Applicable	None
Biological Safety Cabinet EM for E001314								
Surface Sampling of ISO 5 (4 locations)	Daily	22Sep26	AOD	Date Before Testing	No Growth	Not Applicable	Not Applicable	None
Surface Sampling of ISO 5 (4 locations)	Daily	23Sep26	GL	Date of Testing	No Growth	Not Applicable	Not Applicable	None
Surface Sampling of ISO 5 (4 locations)	Daily	24Sep26	AOD	Date After Testing	No Growth	Not Applicable	Not Applicable	None
Settling Sampling of ISO 5 (2 locations)	Daily	22Sep26	AOD	Date Before Testing	No Growth	Not Applicable	Not Applicable	None
Settling Sampling of ISO 5 (2 locations)	Daily	23Sep26	GL	Date of Testing	No Growth	Not Applicable	Not Applicable	None
Settling Sampling of ISO 5 (2 locations)	Daily	24Sep26	AOD	Date After Testing	No Growth	Not Applicable	Not Applicable	None
Weekly Active Air Sampling of Cleanroom Suite 115 (E001737) with Processing BSC								
Active Air Sampling of Cleanrooms	Weekly	23Sep26	SMO	Week of Testing	6 CFUs (ISO 8 115)	ETX-261001-0625	*Micrococcus luteus* *Kocuria indica* *Kocuria rhizophila* Pending FunITS (Hyphae)	None
Weekly Surface Sampling of Cleanroom Suite 115 (E001737) with Processing BSC								
Surface Sampling of Cleanrooms	Weekly	23Sep26	SMO	Week of Testing	No Growth	Not Applicable	Not Applicable	None